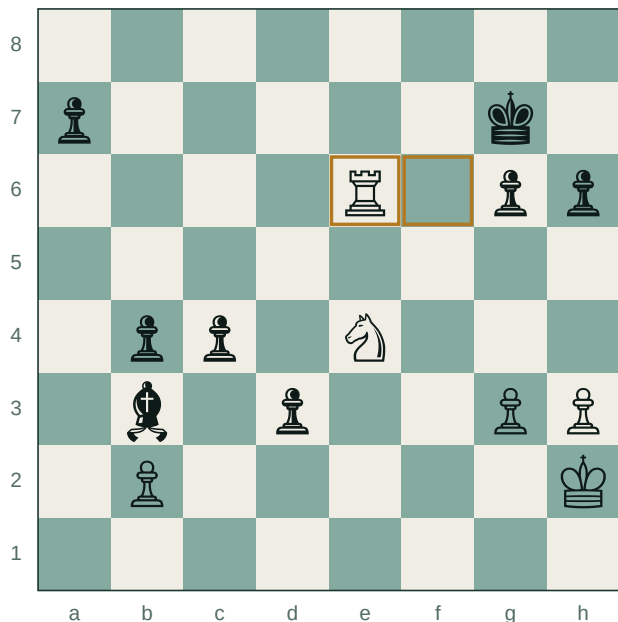


Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 38

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Rxe6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...c3 39. Re7+ Kf8 40. Rxa7 d2

38...c3 The pawn moves from c4 to c3. The changed line means the bishop on b3 attacks the rook on e6. Recorded reply: **39.Re7+**.

39...Kf8 The king moves from g7 to f8. Recorded reply: **40.Rxa7**.

40...d2 The pawn moves from d3 to d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -2 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: rook on e6. Check for tactical protection.